

ROHIT JAIN PARAS

a chance to socialise as well," says his parent Sakshi Kukreja, 36, a homemaker.

At Bark Street, a dog café in Noida, pets and parents can hang out together and enjoy their food. On the pup menu are dog-friendly soups, cupcakes and omelettes. "Dogs are like children and leaving them behind at home is difficult sometimes," says Rahul Narang, co-owner of the space. "Parents really enjoy being out with their dogs and there's demand for pet-friendly spaces." Yummers Barkery in Noida, an exclusive bakery for dogs, fulfils a similar need, offering canine-specific donuts, cupcakes, cookies, pizzas, birthday cakes and ice creams.

And there is simply no dearth of such spaces—cafes, parks, shopping outlets, restaurants and day outing spots that are either dedicated to pets or are pet-friendly—springing up across the country, be it the massive Jio World Drive in Mumbai, the luxurious Café Dori in Delhi or the Petstreet Resort in Noida. Even the iconic Cubbon Park in Bengaluru has a special dog corner.

PET INDULGENCE

Once upon a time, a washdown with the garden pipe along with the family car would suffice as grooming. A dog would then shake itself dry, naturally. Today, high drama attends the business of pet grooming, as they are pampered with the same enthusiasm as any human. The pets themselves can't have enough of the attention, whether it's a deep tissue massage or paw butter to keep their paws hydrated and soft. Haircuts start at Rs 2,400 and spas at Rs 1,900, but prices vary with the size and breed of dog.

STRUTTING THEIR STUFF
A dog fashion show in Jaipur

Leisha Motwani, owner of Mumbai-based Petgascar, says that it's a misconception that only high-end clients or top dog breeds avail of the luxury of pet spas. "Whether it is an indie or a husky, all pet parents come to our spa," says Motwani. "Handling the pet is key to a comfortable experience for them."

Getting pets used to spa treatments is important. Thirty-four-year-old software engineer Prashant Sehgal recalls his first few visits with his six-year-old Persian cat Whisky to the HUFT spa in Bengaluru. He had to take the cat, who was abandoned at age two by his first owner and re-adopted by Sehgal, to see blowdriers at the spa every week for two months till he stopped being afraid of them. A dog or a cat who has never been blow dried or had its nail trimmed till adulthood usually finds it difficult to adjust to being groomed. Whisky is now getting used to his weekly spa treatment. "He starts